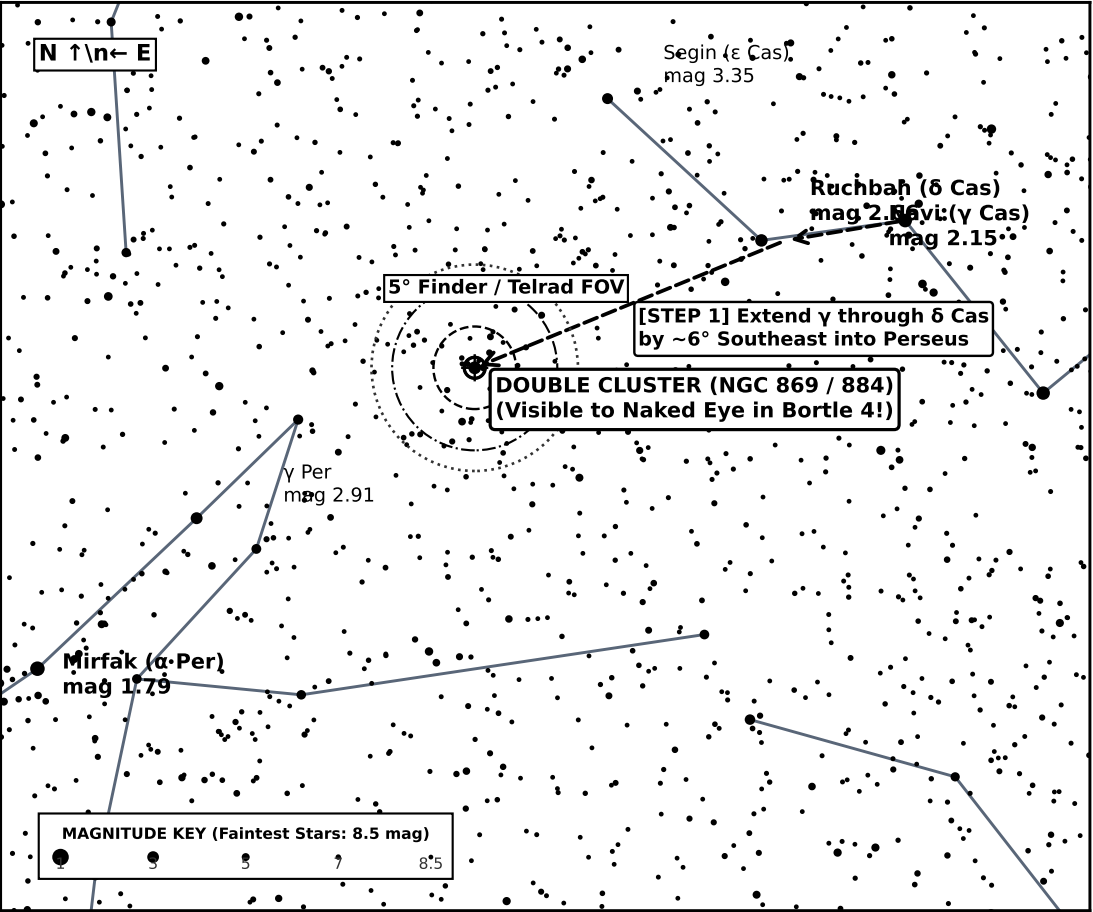


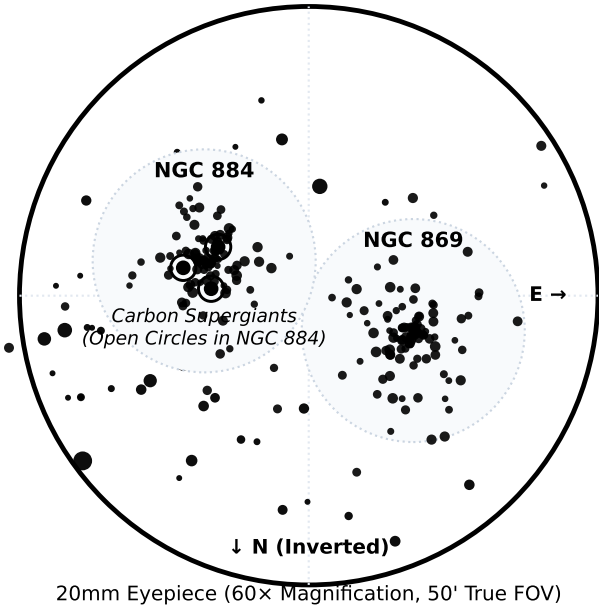
STAR-HOPPING FINDER CHART 5: THE DOUBLE CLUSTER (NGC 869 / NGC 884) — PERSEUS

Location: Dvigrad (Bortle 4, SQM 21.0) | Sep 12, 2026 • 21:15 CEST | Sky-Watcher 200P Dobsonian (8-inch f/6, 1200mm FL) | B/W Toner-Saver Edition

VIEWPORT A: WIDE-FIELD STAR-HOPPING CHART (Upright Naked-Eye / Finder: N ↑, E ←)



VIEWPORT B: EYEPIECE SIMULATION (Negative Inverted 180°: N ↓, E →)



VIEWPORT C: TARGET DOSSIER & STAR-HOPPING INSTRUCTIONS

OBJECT DOSSIER: NGC 869 & NGC 884 (CALDWELL 14)

- Constellation: Perseus | Type: Twin Open Clusters
- Magnitude: 3.7 / 3.8V | Apparent Size: 30' diameter each
- Total Stars: ~600 stars | Distance: ~7,500 light-years
- Tonight's Ephemeris at Dvigrad (Sep 12, 2026):
20:00 CEST: Alt 24.0° | 21:15 CEST: Alt 31.6° (Clear of trees)
22:30 CEST: Alt 40.5°, Az 50° (Peak Crystalline Clarity)

EYEPIECE QUICK REFERENCE & OBSERVING NOTES:

- Primary Eyepiece (20mm / 60×): The ultimate showstopper! Frames both glittering jewel boxes side by side in 50' FOV.
- Carbon Supergiants: Radiant ruby-red/orange supergiant stars (open circles) glowing among blue-white stars in NGC 884.
- Core Zoom (12.5mm / 96×): Resolves dense center of NGC 869.

STEP-BY-STEP STAR HOP NARRATIVE:

1. Naked-Eye: Locate the 'W' of Cassiopeia high in the NE.
2. Draw a line from central star Navi (γ Cas) through Ruchbah (δ Cas, bottom-left vertex of the 'W').
3. Extend that line southeast by the same distance (~6°).
4. An unmistakable glowing mist is visible naked-eye; center Telrad or finder scope directly on it!